

Australia's Parliament House: A History

Exploring the story of our nation's democratic heart
From Old Parliament House to the new building on Capital Hill



What is Parliament House?

The home of Australia's federal government

Where our elected representatives meet to make laws

Houses both the House of Representatives and the Senate

A symbol of Australian democracy



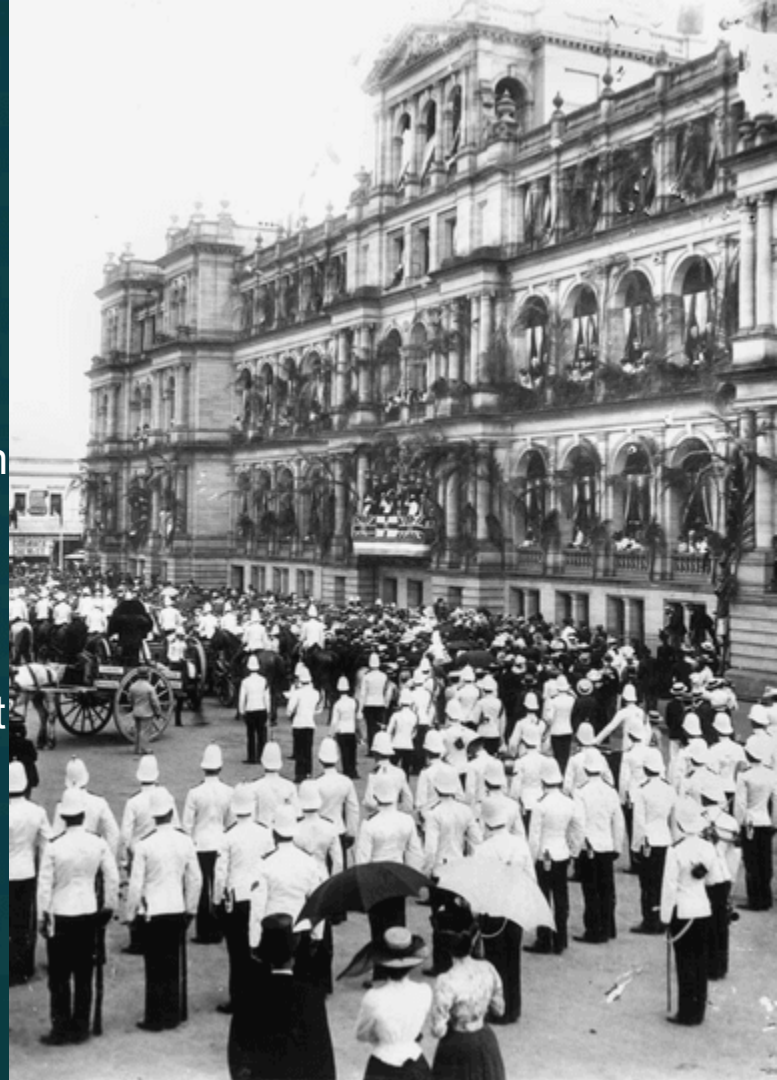
Before Parliament House: The Early Days

Australia became a nation in 1901 through Federation

The first Parliament met in Melbourne

Melbourne was the temporary capital city

Politicians needed a permanent home for government



Choosing Canberra as the Capital

Sydney and Melbourne both wanted to be the capital

A compromise was reached to create a new city

Canberra was chosen as a location between the two cities

The Australian Capital Territory was established in
1911





Life in Old Parliament House

Opened in 1927 as a 'temporary' building

Much smaller than today's Parliament House

Politicians and staff worked in cramped conditions

Important decisions were made here for over 60 years





Design Challenge: Planning a New Parliament

Imagine you're an architect in the 1970s
Australia needs a bigger Parliament House
What features would you include?
Think about: size, location, special rooms,
and symbols



Building the New Parliament House

Construction began in 1981

Took 7 years to build

Cost \$1.1 billion

Designed by American architects Mitchell, Giurgola and Thorp



Special Features of New Parliament House

Built into Capital Hill - you can walk on the roof!

The flagpole is 81 metres tall

Contains over 4,500 rooms

Features Australian art, timber, and stone throughout



"This building belongs to the people of Australia. It is a place where democracy lives and breathes, and where the future of our nation is shaped."



Parliament House Today

